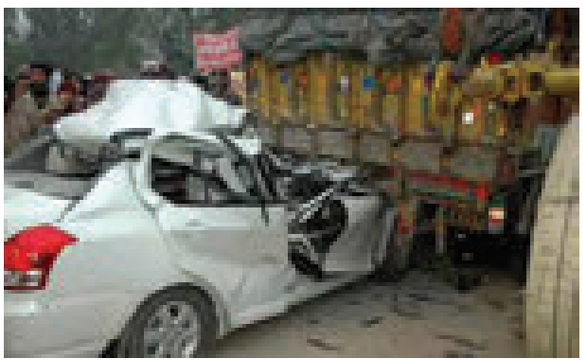
6.9 Road Accidents

Road accidents are certainly the most serious outcome due to defective traffic planning and controlling. The reasons for this are the extremely dense road traffic and the relatively great freedom of movement given to drivers.

In India, road accidents accounted for 480,652 in 2016 which caused 150,785 traffic-related deaths. The three highest total number of fatalities were reported in Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra and Tamil Nadu. Of which Tamil Nadu records the highest road accidents for a decade and its capital Chennai has more accidents than any other city in India. The World Health Organization (WHO) identified the major causes of traffic accidents as driving over the speed limit, driving under the influence, failure to maintain lane and not using helmets and seat belts.



6.9.1 Causes of Road Accidents

Road accidents are caused due to the following reasons

1. Intake of alcohol by driver.
2. Use of mobile phones by the driver during driving and by pedestrians during crossing the road.
3. Driving at overspeed.
4. Violating the traffic rules like wrong lane, jumping red light, etc.,
5. Carelessness on roads.
6. Driver falling asleep, fatigue or sick.
7. Mechanical defect of the vehicle.
8. Engineering/ Design fault of roads like road condition, sight distances, narrow roads, dangerous curves, etc.,
9. Improper street lighting.
10. Unfavourable weather conditions.

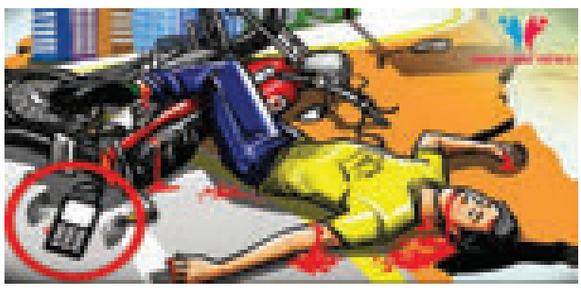
Activity 4

Prepare a report on a recently occurred road accident in your nearby locality, study the causes and give suggestion to prevent it.

6.9.2 Effects of Road Accidents

Road accidents can cause

1. Physical, financial and mental effects for everyone involved.
2. Drivers and passengers can suffer from minor cuts and bruises, broken limbs, back and spinal injuries, paralysis and even death.
3. Vehicles get damaged resulting in complete discarding.
4. Shattering of dreams from losing their loved one.



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